

Nikita Kanarev

Product Designer — B2B products, complex workflows, design systems

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I design **B2B products where the hard part is the constraint, not the canvas** — legacy systems nobody is going to replace, several roles working on one dataset, decisions that carry a real price. For nearly three years I was **the only designer in a product team of six to ten**, holding three products at once: a partner portal for professional integrators, an internal video learning platform, and the corporate site. I reframe the task before designing it, run my own research, and take the work through to a design system and shipped code.

EXPERIENCE

Product Designer — DSSL

Sep 2023 — Mar 2026 • Remote

Distributor of professional video-surveillance equipment. Sole designer in a product team of six to ten — frontend, backend, a product manager, QA and the team lead — across three products, and present at every stage of each: research, information architecture, flows, prototypes, design system, handoff and QA. One designer on three products mostly meant deciding, every week, what would not get designed.

- **B2B partner portal — reframed around the specification, not the catalogue.** The brief asked for a modern interface; the unit of work behind it was a shop's, not a buyer's. An imported purchase line now keeps its provenance — source file, row number, original text, original quantity — from spreadsheet to placed order, so a disputed delivery six weeks later can still point back at it. Redesigned end to end, every page shipped, on top of a pricing and stock system that was never going to be replaced.
- **Owned the design system behind it** — a generic layer plus the domain components the product's argument lives in: procurement tables, resolution rows, price and availability blocks, fulfillment plans. Variant coverage checked by script, not by eye — and nothing was drawn before an audit of the old portal, one cognitive walkthrough per screen.
- **Internal learning platform — both sides of it.** The company records video courses about its own equipment and trains its staff on them. I designed the learner's side — course catalogue, lesson page with the video player, progress, tests and certificates — and the authoring side, where the team uploads footage and assembles a course, plus the responsive version people actually watch on.
- **Corporate site — new sections and product landings** for equipment launches, designed to hold together with the rest of the site instead of accumulating as one-off pages.
- **Said no to automation the data could not back.** An ambiguous purchase line is never resolved on the buyer's behalf, however confident the match: compatibility rules for this equipment are not formalised anywhere I could verify, and automating a check that does not exist moves the risk of a wrong delivery onto the buyer — on site, with a crew already there.

Business results are covered by an NDA and are not published. What I bring to the conversation instead is the compromise stated in full: what the design achieved, what it cost, and who now does more work than before.

Product & web design — independent projects

Jan 2023 — 2026

Client and self-directed work — full-time until autumn 2023, alongside the role above after that.

- Products taken end to end on my own — a DTC e-commerce brand with a product configurator, a mobile marketplace, a desktop B2B SaaS: research, PRD, information architecture, design system, screens, code.
- Four production Webflow builds to designs supplied by others — build only, not my design authorship.

Reframe before designing

Most briefs describe a solution someone already picked. The useful work starts when we go back to what the actual problem was.

Evidence before opinion

There was no researcher on the team, so the research was mine. What a screen cannot prove gets recorded as unconfirmed, not counted as a defect.

Write down what did not work

The order a project runs in is a design decision like any other. Where I got that order wrong is the part of a write-up that is hard to fake.

Constraints are the material

A limit that has survived for years is usually load-bearing. I find out what it holds up before asking for it to be lifted.

Name the trade-off

Every decision I ship carries its cost stated out loud — who now does more work, and what would have to change to remove it.

AI across the pipeline

Several models, picked per step, from the first interview to QA on a built prototype. It drafts and it finds; it does not decide.

SKILLS	PRODUCT	Discovery and problem reframing · PRD · information architecture and user flows · scenarios · scope prioritisation (MoSCoW) · design systems and tokens · component matrices and variant coverage · accessibility to WCAG 2.2 AA
	RESEARCH	Competitive and market analysis · personas · usability audit (Nielsen heuristics, cognitive walkthrough) · scenario testing on built prototypes
	CRAFT	Figma · Storybook · motion design and choreography (GSAP) · desktop-first B2B interfaces, data-dense tables, empty and error states · responsive and mobile web
	CODE	HTML · CSS · TypeScript · React · Astro · Webflow · Git · Vercel — enough to ship the design myself, and to hand over a spec a frontend team does not have to translate
	AI	Claude and Claude Code · multi-model pipelines across a forty-step product playbook · agent-driven QA runs against live prototypes · AI-assisted research and synthesis

EDUCATION	Google UX Design Professional Certificate — Coursera	2025
	UX/UI Design, advanced — Yandex Practicum	2024
	Web Design, professional retraining, 530 h — Pentaschool, Moscow	2022 — 2023
	BSc — Russian State Agrarian University, Moscow	2020

AVAILABILITY

Looking for an in-house product team where design owns the problem and not only the screens — B2B, complex domains, a product with real constraints in it.

Russian citizen, currently based in **Kazakhstan (UTC+5)**. I am **open to relocation — visa sponsorship required**. Remote until then, and flexible about the contracting arrangement — happy to work through whatever setup your company uses. My afternoons overlap with the European morning: four to five hours of shared working time, more if the team is flexible.

English B2 · Russian native